

अथ सप्तमोऽध्यायः ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

आज्ञप्तास्ते ततो दैत्याश्चण्डमुण्डपुरोगमाः ।

चतुरङ्गवलोपेता ययुरभ्युद्यतायुधाः ॥ २ ॥

ददृशुस्ते ततो देवीमीषद्वासां व्यवस्थिताम् ।

सिंहस्योपरि शैलेन्द्रशृङ्गे महति काञ्चने ॥ ३ ॥

ते दृष्ट्वा तां समादातुमुद्यमञ्चक्रुरुद्यताः ।

आकृष्टचापासिधरास्तथाऽन्ये तत्समीपगाः ॥ ४ ॥

1-2. The R̥ṣi said: Then at his command the asuras, fully armed, and with Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa at their head, marched in fourfold array.

3. They saw the Devī, smiling gently, seated upon the lion on a huge golden peak of the great mountain.

4. On seeing her, some of them excited themselves and made an effort to capture her, and others approached her, with their bows bent and swords drawn.

ततः कोपं चकारोच्चैरम्बिका तानरीन्प्रति ।
कोपेन चास्या वदनं मषीवर्णमभूत्तदा ॥ ५ ॥

भ्रुकुटीकुटिलात्तस्या ललाटफलकादुत्तम् ।
काली करालवदना विनिष्क्रान्तासिपाशिनी ॥ ६ ॥

विचित्रखट्वाङ्गधरा नरमालाविभूषणा ।
द्वीपिचर्मपरीधाना शुष्कमांसातिभैरवा ॥ ७ ॥

अतिविस्तारवदना जिह्वाललनभीषणा ।
निमग्नारक्तनयना नादापूरितदिङ्मुखा ॥ ८ ॥

5. Thereupon Ambikā became terribly angry with those foes, and in her anger her countenance then became dark as ink.

6. Out from the surface of her forehead, fierce with frown, issued suddenly Kālī of terrible countenance, armed with a sword and noose.

7-9. Bearing the strange skull-topped staff, decorated with a garland of skulls, clad in a tiger's skin, very appalling owing to her emaciated flesh, with gaping mouth, fearful with her tongue lolling out, having deep-sunk reddish eyes and filling the regions of the sky with her roars, and falling upon impetuously

सा वेगेनाभिपतिता घातयन्ती महासुरान् ।
सैन्ये तत्र सुरारीणामभक्षयत तद्भलम् ॥ ९ ॥

पार्ष्णिग्राहाङ्कुशग्राहियोधवण्टासमन्वितान् ।
समादायैकहस्तेन मुखे चिक्षेप वारणान् ॥ १० ॥

तथैव योधं तुरगै रथं सारथिना सह ।
निक्षिप्य वक्त्रे दशनैश्चर्वयत्यतिमैरवम् ॥ ११ ॥

एकं जग्राह केशेषु ग्रीवायामथ चापरम् ।
पादेनाक्रम्य चैवान्यमुखाऽन्यमपोथयत् ॥ १२ ॥

and slaughtering the great asuras in that army, she devoured those hosts of the foes of the devas.

10. Snatching the elephants with one hand she flung them into her mouth together with their rear, men and drivers and their warrior-riders and bells.

11. Taking likewise into her mouth the cavalry with the horses, and chariot with its driver, she ground them most frightfully with her teeth.

12. She seized one by the hair and another by the neck; one she crushed by the weight of her foot and another, of her body.

तैर्मुक्तानि च शस्त्राणि महास्त्राणि तथासुरैः ।
मुखेन जग्राह रुषा दशनैर्मथितान्यपि ॥ १३ ॥

बलिनां तद्भलं सर्वमसुराणां दुरात्मनाम् ।
ममर्दाभिक्षयच्चान्यानन्यांश्चाताडयत्तथा ॥ १४ ॥

असिना निहताः केचित्केचित्खट्वाङ्गताडिताः ।
जम्बुर्विनाशमसुरा दन्ताग्राभिहतास्तथा ॥ १५ ॥

क्षणेन तद्भलं सर्वमसुराणां निपातितम् ।
दृष्ट्वा चण्डोऽभिदुद्राव तां कालीमतिभीषणाम् ॥ १६ ॥

13. And she caught with her mouth the weapons and the great arms shot by those asuras and crunched them up with her teeth in her fury.

14. She destroyed all that host of mighty and evil-natured asuras, devoured some and battered others.

15. Some were killed with her sword, some were beaten with her skull-topped staff, and other asuras met their death being ground with the edge of her teeth.

16. Seeing all that host of asuras laid low in a moment, Caṇḍa rushed against that Kālī, who was exceedingly terrible.

शरवर्षैर्महाभीमैर्भीमाक्षीं तां महासुरः ।
छादयामास चक्रैश्च मुण्डः क्षिप्तैः सहस्रशः ॥ १७ ॥

तानि चक्राण्यनेकानि विशमानानि तन्मुखम् ।
बभ्रुर्यथाऽर्कविम्बानि सुबहूनि घनोदरम् ॥ १८ ॥

ततो जहासातिरुषा भीमं भैरवनादिनी ।
काली करालवक्त्रान्तर्दुर्दर्शदशनोज्ज्वला ॥ १९ ॥

उत्थाय च महासिंहं देवी चण्डमधावत ।
गृहीत्वा चास्य केशेषु शिरस्तेनासिनाच्छिनत् ॥ २० ॥

17. The great āsura (Caṇḍa) with very terrible showers of arrows, and Muṇḍa with discuses hurled in thousands covered that terrible-eyed (Devī).

18. Those numerous discuses, disappearing into her mouth, looked like numerous solar orbs, disappearing into the midst of a cloud.

19. Thereat Kālī, who was roaring frightfully, whose fearful teeth were gleaming within her dreadful mouth, laughed terribly with exceeding fury.

20. Then the Devī, mounting upon her great lion, rushed at Caṇḍa, and seizing him by his hair severed his head with her sword.

अथ मुण्डोऽभ्यधावत्तां दृष्ट्वा चण्डं निपातितम् ।

तमप्यपातयद्भूमौ सा खड्गाभिहतं रुषा ॥ २१ ॥

हतशेषं ततः सैन्यं दृष्ट्वा चण्डं निपातितम् ।

मुण्डं च सुमहावीर्यं दिशो भैजे भयातुरम् ॥ २२ ॥

शिरश्चण्डस्य काली च गृहीत्वा मुण्डमेव च ।

प्राह प्रचण्डाद्गुहासमिश्रमभ्येत्य चण्डिकाम् ॥ २३ ॥

मया तवात्रोपहतौ चण्डमुण्डौ महापशू ।

युद्धयन्ने स्वयं शुम्भं निशुम्भं च हनिष्यसि ॥ २४ ॥

21. Seeing Caṇḍa laid low, Muṇḍa also rushed at her. She felled him also to the ground, striking him with her sword in her fury.

22. Seeing the most valiant Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa laid low, the remaining army there became panicky and fled in all directions.

23. And Kālī, holding the heads of Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa in her hands, approached Caṇḍikā and said, her words mingled with very loud laughter :

24. 'Here have I brought you the heads of Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa as two great animal offerings in this sacrifice of battle; Śumbha and Niśumbha, you shall yourself slay.'

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ २५ ॥

तावानीतौ ततो दृष्ट्वा चण्डमुण्डौ महासुरौ ।

उवाच कालीं कल्याणी ललितं चण्डिका वचः ॥ २६ ॥

यस्माच्चण्डं च मुण्डं च गृहीत्वा त्वमुपागता ।

चामुण्डेति ततो लोके ख्याता देवी भविष्यसि ॥ २७ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
चण्डमुण्डवधो नाम सप्तमोऽध्यायः ॥

25-27. The Ṛṣi said: Thereupon seeing those asuras, Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa brought to her, the auspicious Caṇḍikā said to Kālī these playful words: 'Because you have brought me both Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa, you, O Devī, shall be famed in the world by the name Cāmuṇḍā.'

Here ends the seventh chapter called 'The slaying of Caṇḍa and Muṇḍa' of Devī-māhātmya in Mārkaṇḍeyapurāṇa, during the period of Sāvarni, the Manu.

